

Waymo's objective is to make its cars viable across all roads, where they would be able to identify minor obstacles from major ones, realise manual traffic alerts a-la police officers, and iron out these glitches from the software. Of the 15 accidents that Google (and Waymo) have been involved in, the other human drivers were at fault for 14 out of the 15 times. For the solitary mistake that its cars have made, it mistook sandbags as obstacles that needed to be avoided, and veered off course to bump into a bus that was passing on its side lane.

Waymo will also intend to refine the design of these cars, and find a way to retrofit the Lidar and other sensors in a way as to not disrupt the visual appeal of our future vehicle. In short, Waymo now has all the hardware it needs for the autonomous cars. All it needs now, is the perfect software.

Android Auto

It is in search of this perfect software that Android Auto came into being. While self-driving cars are certainly much more exciting and challenging, the need to provide a familiar infotainment interface for the millions of Android smartphone users worldwide became a compelling case for Google.

At I/O 2014, Google announced Android Auto as a simplified, ergonomic interface for drivers to access connected applications via a car's infotainment system. A few months earlier, at the Consumer Electronics Show 2014,



Google's most successful auto effort so far